

MUSIC

Culture CLUB

The Society for Promotion of Indian Classical Music and Culture Amongst Youth is one of the finest movements in India that introduces performing arts to young people. For the iPod generation to see all over the country, starting August 27.



ULHAS KASHALKAR

As a boy from Pandharkarwa village in Yavatmal district, Maharashtra, Ulhas Kashalkar, 54, grew up learning from his father, N.D. Kashalkar, Pandit Ram Marathe and Pandit Gajananbua Joshi. A purist, his music is seeped in melody and his *taankari* and *layakari* are perfect. The *gharana gayaki* is so evident of the nuances from Gwalior, Agra and Jaipur gharana. He believes that one does need to copy the guru but assimilate.



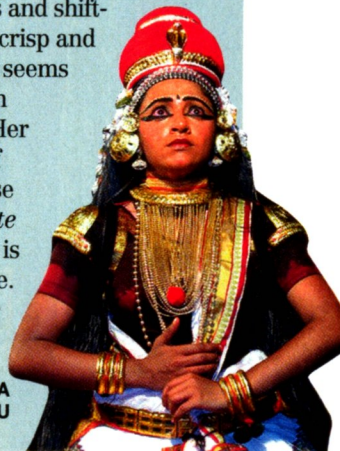
SHASHANK

Shashank, 30, has been a child prodigy and charmed listeners worldwide with his flute. He learnt from the Carnatic flautist, T.R. Mahalingam, who first advised him to learn vocal music from Palghat K.V. Narayana Swamy. Now he is learning Hindustani classical music with Pandit Jasraj. His recitals showcase an extraordinary range of musical expression. Apart from classical, he also dabbles in fusion music.

There is a revival of 2,000-year-old art form Kutiyattam, the world's oldest theatre art and the only surviving Sanskrit theatre belonging to Kerala. Watch the young Kapila Venu, 26, the star female performer from Ammanur Chachu Chakyar Gurukulam. She is not only a performer but also a choreographer. Her meticulous eye movements and shifting of gaze are crisp and calculated. She seems possessed when she performs. Her performance of Jayadeva's verse *Vedanuddharate Jagannivahate* is worth your time.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

KAPILA VENU



THEATRE

Child's Play

What AHA! International Theatre Festival for Children brings a variety of plays, symposiums, conferences and workshops aimed at creating a new vocabulary in children's theatre. Besides India, plays from Australia, Germany and Argentina will also be performed.

Who B. Jayashree's *Lakshapati Rajana Kathe*, *Veriyattam* by Kattakuttu from Kancheepuram, *The Stones* from Australia, *The Garbage Mouse* and *Lalula* from Germany and *Pirates Code* from Argentina.

When and where From August 26 to September 6 at Ranga Shankara, Bangalore.

by Nirmala Ravindran



THE GARBAGE MOUSE

ART EXHIBITION

Postcard Perfect

When everything is becoming larger-than-life, Card-O-Logy, comes as a welcome break. In an exhibition of over 300 picture postcards by 61 artists, viewers will be exposed to an "intimate experience" of seeing art. Ranging from Rs 3,000 to Rs 10,000, the postcards will bear drawings, sketches, etchings and photographs. The artists include Arunanshu Chowdhury, Amit Ambalal and others. At Hacienda Gallery, Mumbai, from September 4 to 18.

by Swati Mathur

